



Mary Star ^{OF THE} Sea
Elementary & Middle School

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Intermediate Team Faculty

Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Syllabus: 2026-2027 Grade 5 English

Welcome to Grade 4. This syllabus is intended to help you, the student, develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me. For English, my primary focus will be to complete this year with all students developing a love for, and a grade-level understanding of, books, writing, language, and grammar.

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission Statement:

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question: How can I model Kindness, Fairness & Humility like Jesus?

Course Overview

English: This course focuses on developing reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills. Students will engage with classic and modern literature, explore grammar and vocabulary, and practice various forms of writing.

Students will complete in school-wide STAR Standardized Testing at the beginning, middle, and end of the school year to monitor their overall academic progress.

CLASS NOVELS:

This school year, students will read four core novels as a class, along with supplemental materials to be provided. Some are classic novels that parents might recognize; others are likely unfamiliar. The novels will be provided by the school, unless otherwise specified, at a later time. 5th grade novels will align with the different literacy lessons taught in each quarter. The 5th-grade core novels include the following:

- Quarter 1 *The One and Only Ivan* by Katherine Applegate

- Quarter 2 *Who Was Series* by Numerous Authors (Students will be assigned a different historical person to read about)
- Quarter 3 *Tuck Everlasting* Natalie Babbitt
- Quarter 4 *A Wrinkle in Time* by Madeleine L'Engle

Reading and Writing

- Q1- Reading Workshop and Analyzing Themes / Narrative Writing
- Q2- Levels of Non-Fiction / Research Reports
- Q3- Argument and Advocacy: Researching Debatable Issues/ Argument Essay
- Q4- Reading Fantasy: The Magic of Themes and Symbols/ Shaping Texts: From Essay and Narrative to Memoir

Grammar and Vocabulary

- Q1- Sentences & Nouns /Multiple-Meaning Words, Context Clues, Homographs, Analogies
- Q2- Verbs, Pronouns and Contractions/ Words Often Confused Suffixes (-ment,-ance, -age, -hood) Prefixes (pre-, in-, im-ir-, il-, ; Thesaurus
- Q3- Adding Detail Context Clues, Roots (port,mit), Homophones, Prefixes (re-, in-, im-), Suffixes (-ion, -tion,-sion, -ous, -ic)
- Q4- Conjunctions, Commas, Dialogue / Multiple Meaning Words Roots (spect,photo, tele), Suffixes (-ity, -ty, -ence, -al), Prefixes (de-, post-, trans-, sub-), Roots (dic, tract)

GRADING POLICY:

English

- 35% Written Work (e.g., journals, reports, projects, etc.)
- 30% Classwork, Homework and Guided Practice
- 25% Assessments (Oral/Written Tests and Quizzes)
- 10% Participation and Collaboration

*Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic grade book via your Beehively account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance. ***Beehively will serve as the primary source for monitoring grades, missing assignments, and academic progress throughout the school year.***

HOMEWORK POLICY:

Students are expected to read 20 minutes every day. In addition to the reading, other homework will be assigned. Your child's teachers will work together to ensure that students receive a balanced homework regimen that fosters a positive learning environment and nurtures their intellectual growth. Assignments are expected to be written daily in a student's planner and available on Google Calendar. Parents are expected to check the student's planner daily, support their child in time management and follow through. Late work will be accepted; however, late assignments may negatively affect students' participation grades.

CLASSROOM EXPECTATIONS:

- Students are expected to come to class prepared and ready to learn.
- Homework should be completed daily and turned in. If there is a reason the homework cannot be completed on time, the teacher should be notified in advance, and a plan should be made to complete the assignment.
- Students are expected to always try their best and participate in class. Further, they are expected to ask questions, request clarification, and communicate via office hours or email as needed.
- Students are expected to respect themselves, respect others, and respect all property.
- **Class Incentives:** Individual Treasure Box visit, class community rewards
- **Class Consequences:**
 - Step 1: Verbal reminder
 - Step 2: One-on-one discussion, written self-reflection
 - Step 3: Parent contact

REQUIRED MATERIALS:

Students should be prepared on a daily basis with the following:

- English composition book
- Core novel
- Erasable pen, pencil, eraser and highlighter
- Sticky notes
- Index cards
- Planner

Important Dates:

Orientation: August 12, 2026

Parent-Teacher Conferences

- Fall 9/10-11, 2026
- Spring 2/19/27 (Optional)

Expeditions:

- Q1: 9/28/2026 Coconut Island
- Q2: 11/17/2026 Pearl Harbor
- Q3: 3/5/2027 'Iolani Palace
- Q4: 6/1/2027 Niu Valley Hike

School Spelling Bee: November 20th, 2026

Christmas Performance: December 18th, 2026

End-of-Year Awards: June 3rds, 2027

TEACHER CONTACT

→ **Contact me via email:** asoto-gelacio@starofthesea.org

◆ Please allow up to 24 hours for a response on school days.

→ **In-person office hours:** 2:45-3:15 p.m. (M-F)

EMPOWERED TO SUCCEED, GUIDED BY FAITH ❤️!